CHRISCO
YOUTH
AFLAME



UNUSED IS LOST

The Law of Use and the Law of Sowing and Reaping

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Welcome To

Unused Is Lost

Two laws that decide what a life becomes

FOREWORD

Some sentences are so small that you walk past them, and so true that you never do. This book is built on one of those: **whatever you don't use, you lose.** An older man handed it to a younger one a long time ago, and the younger man spent the rest of his life proving it.

It is not a proverb about money. It is a law about everything you have been given. It does not send a warning letter; it simply takes back what you refuse to put to work.

- **Law One · Use**
- **Law Two · Sow**



Our Vision

A generation of young people who put everything God gave them to work, and who are not found with a buried gift in their hands.

Our Mission

To teach the two basic laws in plain language, in our own words, to every young person who will read: the law of use and the law of sowing and reaping, then send them out to practise them in the ordinary fields of home, church, school and work.

Core Values

Unused is lost · Sown is not



Use What You Have

Every gift has a maintenance cost and the fee is use. We start with what is already in our hands.



Sow Where You Are

We do not wait for a bigger field. We plant in the one we can see, this week, with what we have.



The Two Laws At A Glance

Basic Laws

Law One · Use

Whatever you don't use, you lose. Talent, ability, ambition, vitality, energy, strong feelings, faith: unused, every one of them declines.

Law Two · Sow

Whatever you are reaping is what you have sown. If the crop is bitter, the farmer is not hard to find.

The Turn

You cannot fix a harvest. You can change a seed, and you can start today.

Part One

The Law Of Use

Nothing you own stays yours by accident. Every gift carries a maintenance cost, and the fee is use. This first part is the audit: what have you been given, and what are you doing with it?

What The Law Says







The law of use is quiet and it is ruthless. It never argues with you, never sends a bill on the day. It waits, and then it closes the window. A talent unused is lost. An ability unused is lost. It is a law.

Four chapters, one question

Nobody Votes On It

CHAPTER ONE

The law does not ask your opinion. It does not bring your case up for a vote.

Whatever You Don't Use, You Lose



There is a kind of person who says, “I'll work twice as hard tomorrow to make up for today.” That is arithmetic that feels honest and is not. The day is not a bank; you cannot deposit it back.

Tie your arm to your side. Leave it there long enough and you will never use it again. Not because anything dramatic happened, but because you stopped. Stopping was enough. If you quit, you lose automatically. They do not bring it up for a vote.

So take an inventory

- **Talent**
  What am I good at that I have not touched this year?
- **Ambition**
  Unused, it does not stay at full strength; it declines into cynicism.
- **Faith**
  Not faith spoken about. Faith exercised. Unused, it decreases.

Seven Things That Leak

CHAPTER TWO

The law of use does not only apply to money or muscles. It applies to the invisible things that decide what a life becomes. Name them plainly and they stop being vague.

01 Talent

Unusually good at it, unusually lazy about it. It does not wait forever.

02 Ability

Talent you have trained. Untrained, it stays a rumour.

03 Ambition

Unused, it declines into cynicism about people who still want things.

04 Vitality

It diminishes in the body first, long before you notice.

05 Energy

You cannot store it like grain. Rest is not storage.

06 Strong feelings

Conviction and compassion grow only by being acted on.

07 Faith

Not faith spoken about. Faith exercised. Unused, it decreases.

Seven things. One law. And a mercy inside it: the leak is reversible while you can still read these words.

The Servant Who Played It Safe

MATTHEW 25:14 TO 30 · THREE SERVANTS, ONE BURIED TALENT

He Was Not Condemned For The Talent

A master went on a journey and handed his property to three servants: five talents, two, and one. The first two traded and doubled. The third wrapped his in cloth, dug a hole, and buried it. He handed it back exactly as received, and called that a success.

The verdict is one of the hardest sentences in the Bible: the talent is taken from him and given to the man who already has ten. Not because he was cruel, but because he was idle. He had confused doing no harm with doing good.



The buried gift

- **Safety is not obedience**
  Burying the talent was the one thing he could have done differently.
- **What is wrapped in cloth?**
  Name it tonight. Dig it up this week. Put it to work before Sunday.

Take A New Inventory

CHAPTER FOUR · WORKSHEET

An inventory is not a guilt trip. It is a map. Fill it in honestly, in pencil, and revisit it every quarter.

WHAT I HAVE BEEN GIVEN	WHERE I LAST USED IT	ONE WAY TO USE IT

Three questions

The gift people keep thanking me for is…

The thing I have called "not yet" for over a year is…

What I would attempt this month if I truly believed unused is lost:

Show this page to one person who loves you and is not impressed by you. Then act on the first line before Sunday.

“You don't lose your gift in a tragedy. You lose it on an ordinary Tuesday.”

BETWEEN PART ONE AND PART TWO

UNUSED IS LOST

Part Two

The Law Of Sowing

If the harvest is bitter, the question is not why God is doing this. The question is who planted it, and you will find the farmer in the mirror.

You Reap What You've Sown







The same machinery that ruins a careless life will quietly build a faithful one. Many ways to sow. Anyone can. The only question is whether you will.

Seven keys, one month

Look In The Mirror

CHAPTER FIVE

Two readings of one law, and only the second one is useful.

Whatever You Are Reaping Is What You Have Sown



The polite version is: you reap what you sow. Everyone nods at that; it makes a good poster. The honest version is: whatever you are reaping is what you have sown. That one has a name and an address.

If the crop is the problem, you cannot fix the crop, but you can change the seed, and you can start today. This is not fatalism. It is the most hopeful doctrine in the world, because it puts the harvest back inside your reach.

Be not deceived

"Be not deceived; God is not mocked: for whatsoever a man soweth, that shall he also reap."
Galatians 6:7

Seven Keys To Sowing

CHAPTER SIX

Learn them like you learned your own name, because they explain almost every outcome you will live through.

01 **Negative**
Sow bad, reap bad. Nobody escapes it by being sincere, well-liked or young.

02 **Positive**
Sow good, reap good. Same machinery, faithful crop.

03 **More**
You get back much more than you put out, in both directions.

04 **Many ways**
Many ways to change a life. Do not fixate on the one door you are angry at.

05 **Anyone can**
The question was never can. It is will.

06 **You can still lose**
Sometimes you do it right and lose. Be ready; do not be bitter.

07 **No sow, no reap**
Not a smaller harvest. No harvest at all.

Don't try to beat the law. You might as well sit on the sun to keep it from coming up.

The Seed Already In Your Hand

CHAPTER SEVEN

You may be reading this with very little: no salary, no title, no platform, a rented room and a phone with a cracked screen. Good. The law of sowing does not require capital. It requires seed, and you already have some.



- **Time**
  The most honest seed you own.
- **Words**
  Encouragement sown in private returns as courage in public.
- **Work**
  Excellence in an unglamorous task is seed in the ground.
- **Money**
  However small. Generosity is the only thing you can give away and keep.
- **Attention**
  What you study becomes what you can carry for others.
- **Presence**
  Showing up for people who cannot repay you.

Sow in the field you can see

"He which soweth sparingly shall reap also sparingly; and he which soweth bountifully shall reap also bountifully."
2 Corinthians 9:6

Thirty Days Of Sowing



CHAPTER EIGHT

A law you agree with changes nothing. A law you practise changes everything. One month, small enough to finish.

Week 1

Sow in your walk with God

Fifteen minutes a day in Scripture and prayer. Same chair, no phone.

Week 2

Sow in your body

Three sessions of movement, one earlier night, one honest meal plan.

Week 3

Sow in a person

Four hours given to somebody younger or needier than you.

Week 4

Sow in your craft

Forty-five minutes a day on the thing you want to be excellent at. Doing it.

Grade yourself on days sown

Results are God's department; sowing is yours. Keep the book open on a table for thirty days and write one line a day. A law you agree with changes nothing. A law you practise changes everything.

My Thirty Days

MY THIRTY DAYS

One line a day. Grade yourself on days sown, not on results.

DAY	WHAT I SOWED	WHAT I NOTICED
01		
02		
03		
04		
05		
06		
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Life is brief, and not in a sad way, only in a brief way. The year you are in will pass whether or not you plant anything in it, and it will not come back to be used properly.

From The Ministry Desk

Don't Let The Springs Pass



Take a new inventory of yourself. Make sure all of your talent, your mind, your faith and your courage are being used. Otherwise you lose. It is a law. Then go and sow. Not tomorrow, not after the exams, the wedding or the salary. Now, with what you have, in the field you can see.

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A Prayer To Close

COMMISSIONING

Father, thank You for what You have placed in my hands. Show me what I have buried, and give me the courage to dig it up. Teach me to sow where I am, with what I have, while I still can. Make my life a field and not a warehouse. In the name of Jesus, amen.

"They that sow in tears shall reap in joy."
Psalm 126:5

Go And Sow

Where	What	When
Home · Church · School · Work	**Time · Words · Work · Money**	**Today, not next week**

Notes

NOTES & RESOLUTIONS

Credits And Acknowledgements

BOOK ONE

UNUSED IS LOST is Book One of the CHRISCO Youth Aflame library, a ministry of CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches, written for young people roughly fifteen to thirty and the adults who refuse to give up on them.

The two laws are set out in a talk by Jim Rohn on basic laws taken from Scripture. This is an original work in our own words, not a transcript and not an authorised edition. Scripture: King James Version (public domain).

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